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Budding Entrepreneurs Forum

JULY -2025 NEWSLETTER

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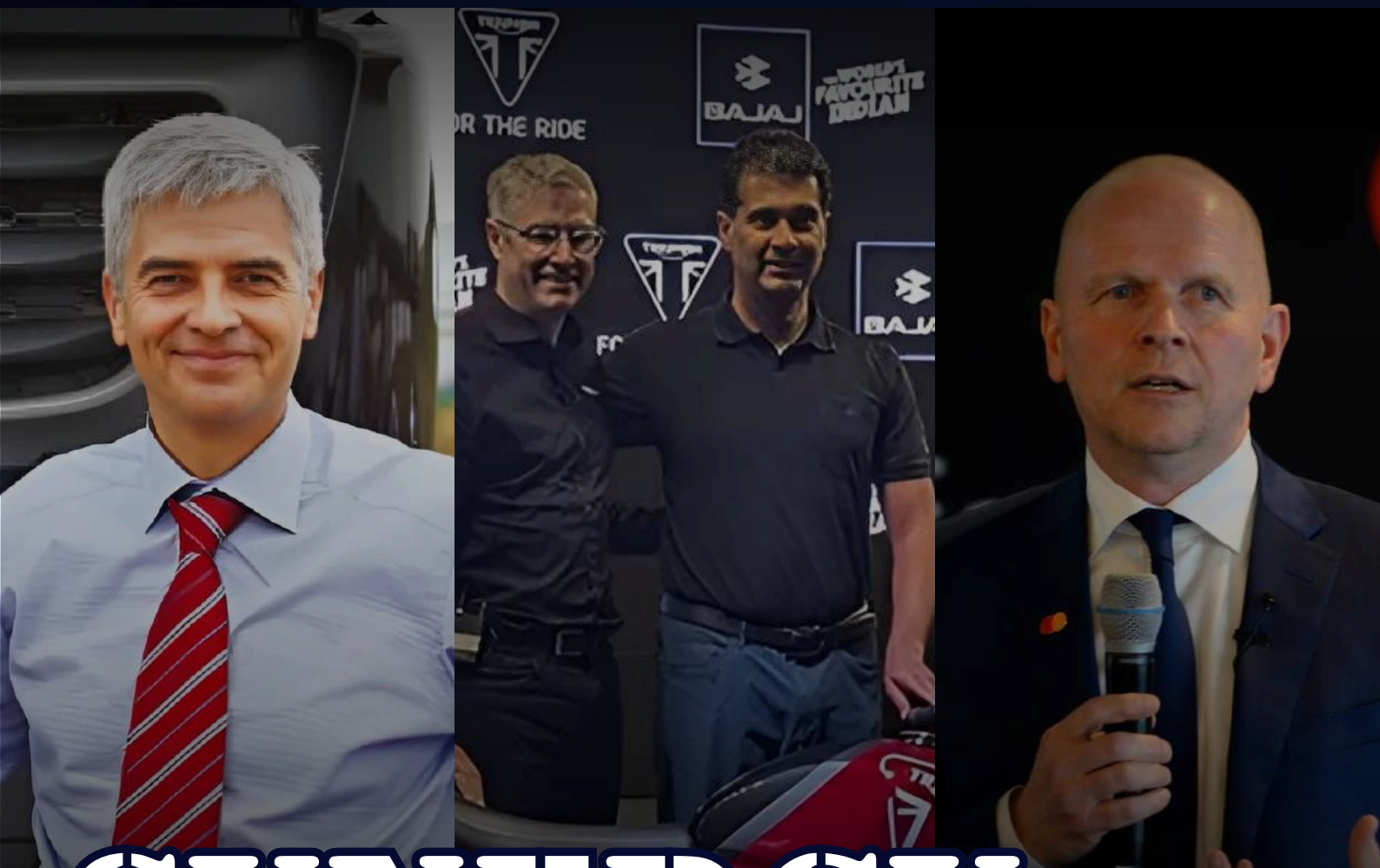
BUDDING ENTREPRENEURS FORUM



SYNERGY STORIES

Winning Brand Collaborations

INTRODUCTION

Brand alliances have evolved from experiments in marketing to powerful strategic maneuvers in today's competitive marketplace. If done right, such collaborations create more than a buzz; they bring audiences together, amplify ideals, and bring new avenues of innovation and commerce. Successful brand alliances go beyond co-branding and leverage a shared vision or cultural moment, such as the examples of Nike x Apple and Supreme x Louis Vuitton.

Synergy is the answer: a harmony in which each brand brings its unique strengths, supporting and reinforcing rather than detracting from each other. These collaborations work because they are founded on mutual benefit, pertinence, and genuineness. The opportunities are limitless—and lucrative—whether it's a technology firm joining forces with a fitness brand to enhance user experience or an upscale fashion brand teaming up with a streetwear brand to redefine style.

"Synergy Stories" explores these pairings that have not only resonated with customers but also disrupted industry standards and brand personas. They are a template for creativity, influence, and narrative in an era of fickle consumers' attention spans and loyalty to achieve. They are movements, not just advertising campaigns. And they make a lasting impact when done correctly.

WATCH |

Written By:
Vedashree Ghotkar
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POWERING DIGITAL GROWTH: THE STRATEGIC COLLABORATION BETWEEN PAYTM AND HDFC BANK

Recognizing the dynamic evolution of India's financial landscape, Paytm and HDFC Bank formally announced a significant strategic partnership in 2021. The core objective of this collaboration was to fundamentally enhance the availability and sophistication of digital payment solutions by effectively merging Paytm's cutting-edge fintech expertise with HDFC Bank's robust retail and credit infrastructure, leveraging its vast established presence.

This productive collaboration allowed both entities to effectively utilize their respective strengths. Paytm brought its significant digital reach and large customer base, while HDFC Bank offered its trusted banking services. A key outcome for Paytm was the launch of co-branded credit cards, significantly enhancing customer interaction and helping promote financial inclusion, especially in semi-urban and rural regions. By utilizing Paytm's merchant network and cutting-edge technology, HDFC Bank was also able to expand their digital presence and attract younger, tech-savvy customers seeking contemporary banking solutions.

Additionally, this partnership accelerated the adoption of digital payments and aided the government's initiatives to advance a cashless economy. This joint effort spurred growth for both Paytm and HDFC Bank, increasing customer numbers, expanded product availability, and overall revenue development. It stands as a prime example of how traditional banking can successfully integrate with fintech innovation to empower individuals financially and achieve lasting profitability.

HDFC BANK

to launch co-branded cards with

Paytm

Written By:
Priyanka Nagar
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BAJAJ & TRIUMPH:
A PARTNERSHIP DRIVEN BY PERFORMANCE

Strategic partnerships form an integral part of today's competitive marketplace, allowing companies to collaborate on their strength, share resources, and benefit from one another's market standing. A case in point is the partnership between the United Kingdom's Triumph Motorcycles and India's Bajaj Auto.

Established to co-manufacture mid-capacity motorcycles, the partnership is focusing on the rapidly growing under-400cc segment, apt for growth markets such as India. Bajaj contributes cost-effective manufacturing and extensive distribution channels, while Triumph contributes premium brand value and technical competence. The partnership enables Triumph to access new customers in Asia, and Bajaj to transition to more globally-sounding products.

Their combined efforts have led to the "Triumph Speed 400" and "Scrambler 400X" which have been launched under the Triumph brand but produced by Bajaj in India. These motorcycles are a mix of new-age retro looks, latest features, and reasonable prices, making premium motorcycling within reach.

This alliance illustrates the potential for merging local manufacturing knowledge with international brand worthiness to restructure industry norms.

Written By:
Nishant Inamdar
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BHARATBENZ × TATA DELTA ELECTRONICS: POWERING THE NEXT GENERATION OF COMMERCIAL MOBILITY

As India speeds toward electrification and digital innovation, strategic partnerships are paving the way. A notable example is the collaboration between BharatBenz, Daimler India's commercial vehicle brand, and Tata Delta Electronics, a leader in EV charging and power solutions.

BharatBenz is renowned for its high-performance trucks and buses built for India's growing transport needs. Delta Electronics, with decades of expertise, brings advanced EV charging, energy management, and automation technologies to the table.

Together, they're addressing a major challenge in India's EV journey, limited charging infrastructure. Their joint initiative will establish over 250 fast-charging stations across logistics hubs, highways, and industrial corridors. Delta will lead with cutting-edge, energy-efficient chargers, while BharatBenz provides location insights based on vehicle traffic and usage patterns.

But this collaboration goes beyond just setting up charging points. It's about creating a reliable, scalable ecosystem that enables clean, efficient commercial transportation. Reduced downtime for fleet operators, smoother long-haul transport, and sustainable last-mile delivery are just a few of the benefits.

In a connected world, the most successful companies grow by building ecosystems. This alliance is a clear step toward a smarter, cleaner, and future-ready India.

BHARATBENZ

DELTA

Written By:
Sushmita Poojari
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JIO + BLACKROCK: WHEN INDIA MEETS WALL STREET

In a powerful example of global synergy, Jio Financial Services, part of the Reliance Group, teamed up with BlackRock, the world's largest asset management firm, in 2023. Their mission? To reshape how Indians invest by building a tech-first, low-cost digital investment platform for the country's rapidly growing population of young and first-time investors.

Jio brings deep digital reach, massive customer trust, and an understanding of Indian consumer behavior. BlackRock contributes global financial expertise, proven investment strategies, and decades of experience. Together, they're tackling one of India's biggest financial gaps — the fact that only a small percentage of people currently invest in mutual funds or financial products.

What makes this collaboration exciting is that it's not just about profits. It's about access. Making investing simpler, smarter, and more inclusive for the average Indian. And doing it in a way that feels native to how Indians already use technology — through smartphones and apps.

For budding entrepreneurs, this story is a goldmine of inspiration. You don't need to build everything yourself. Sometimes, the smartest move is to collaborate with someone who complements what you lack. Local knowledge paired with global muscle can create a game-changing solution.

So, as you build your own startup or venture, ask yourself:
Who can I collaborate with to multiply my impact?
Because in today's world, partnerships aren't just strategy — they're survival.

Written By:
Harsha Saraf
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AMAZON X AMEX:
A SMARTER WAY TO POWER BUSINESS

When two powerhouses like Amazon and American Express join forces, the result is a game-changer for businesses across the U.S. Their collaboration, centered around the Amazon Business Prime American Express Card, is not just about transactions—it's about transformation.

Imagine you're a small business owner ordering supplies, tech, or office essentials from Amazon. With this card, every purchase can either earn generous cashback or offer extended payment terms—giving you the flexibility to manage cash flow on your terms. Whether you're a startup founder ordering laptops or a boutique owner restocking shelves, this card adapts to your rhythm.

The perks go beyond rewards. Cardholders enjoy enhanced purchase protection, expense tracking tools, and exclusive benefits that make day-to-day operations smoother. It's a blend of Amazon's seamless shopping ecosystem and Amex's trusted financial tools—designed to help businesses grow, not just survive.

This partnership is more than just a product. It's a symbol of how finance and e-commerce can come together to create real value. For entrepreneurs juggling invoices, inventories, and innovation, the Amazon-Amex alliance offers a lifeline—smart, secure, and scalable.
In a world where time is money, they're offering both.

Written By:
Tanaya Zad
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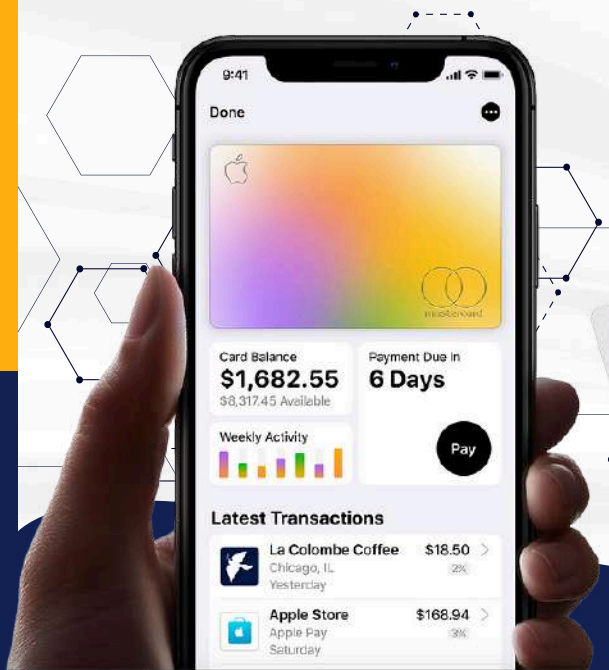
SYNERGY, APPLE & MASTERCARD:
A BOLD STEP TOWARD SMARTER LIVING

Convenience, speed, and security are no longer luxuries today in today's high-speed digital age—they're expectations. Synergy has realized this change and partnered with two of the world's biggest players, Apple and Mastercard, to provide customers with a smarter, more intuitive way to make payments and access extra value in their lives every day. This isn't about launching a new feature, but about building a connected experience that integrates into the lifestyle of contemporary users seamlessly.

With this collaboration, Synergy card users can now connect their Mastercard-ready cards directly with Apple Wallet. This integration allows easy tap-to-pay transactions, without having to hold physical cards or use cash. Whether buying a coffee, hailing a cab, or shopping online, users can make a payment with the touch of an iPhone or Apple Watch. It's convenient, secure, and in line with today's mobile-first culture. By leveraging Apple's well-established reputation for privacy and Mastercard's international reach, the solution provides both peace of mind and broad applicability.

What makes this alliance stand out is the bespoke experience. Synergy customers are treated to privileged benefits, including priority access to Apple product launches, tailored offers, lifestyle rewards, and spending habits-based loyalty points. Here, convenience is not only about speed, but about crafting emotional and memorable experiences. This indicates that Synergy knows its audience—is fast-moving, tech-savvy consumers who appreciate efficiency as well as emotion in brand relationships.



Written By:
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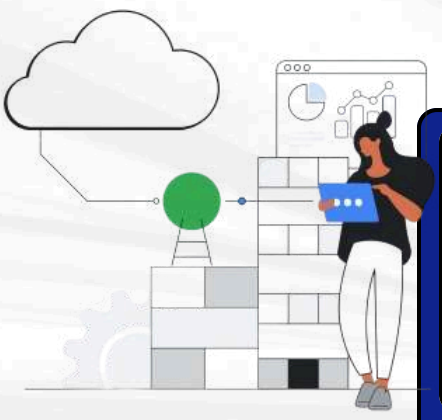
GOOGLE CLOUD AND SAP:
LAUNCHING THE FUTURE OF BUSINESS TECH

In this high technology era, partnerships make all the difference and the alliance between Google Cloud and SAP is a prime example of the same. SAP expertise in enterprise systems alongside Google Cloud power in infrastructure and AI, the two companies are helping businesses redefine how they interpret and use technology.

This collaboration is monumental in a way as they have integrated SAP Datasphere with tools like Google's BigQuery and AI features. For Giant companies, it basically means putting together scattered data into one big space where it all would make sense—and additionally it works in real time. This particular shift has helped leaders make decisions faster, interpret data in real time and ultimately come up with better results.

The main agenda here is that the benefits go both ways. Google Cloud is learning from SAP's understanding of business operation and its enormous customer base. And at the same time, SAP is tapping into Google's cloud innovation to help modernize operations. Together, they are bringing solutions that are not just smart but are also useful in the everyday realities and juggles of the business.

This Partnership isn't just related to tech. It is solving real problems and helping companies move forward with handful risks and superior tools. The Google Cloud-SAP partnership showcases us what can happen when two strong players come together not to compete, but amalgamate. How companies so big in their domains can work alongside to make a business model worth watching.



Written By:
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CONCLUSION:
BRAND COLLABORATIONS THAT WORK

Brand collaboration is a planned alliance formed between two or more businesses with the purpose of meeting common goals. This approach enables each company to draw on the other's strengths, such as skills, assets, and market presence, to create new offerings and broaden their audience. By working together, companies can enhance visibility, share customer bases, and lower the costs of promotion and innovation.

Collaborations can take many forms—joint marketing, co-branded products, shared events, or even digital campaigns. These efforts result in a more diverse offering for consumers and help businesses penetrate new markets. For a partnership to succeed, the involved brands must share similar core values, audience focus, and future objectives. If this alignment is missing, the collaboration can result in confusion or weaken the identity of the brands involved.

An organized strategy helps each brand leverage its unique capabilities while reducing potential drawbacks. This involves clear planning, defining specific targets, and keeping consistent communication across all parties involved. When managed properly, collaborations lead to cost efficiency, innovation, wider market access, and improved consumer engagement.

In the current market environment, where customer expectations and competition are continuously evolving, brand partnerships act as a strategic solution to remain relevant. This approach encourages shared development and creates opportunities for ongoing innovation. Therefore, brand partnerships serve not just as a marketing method but also as a lasting business strategy aimed at boosting profits, enhancing user satisfaction, and strengthening market position.

Written By:
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TURNING MOMENTS INTO MOVEMENTS
THE MAGIC OF OUR BRANDING TEAM

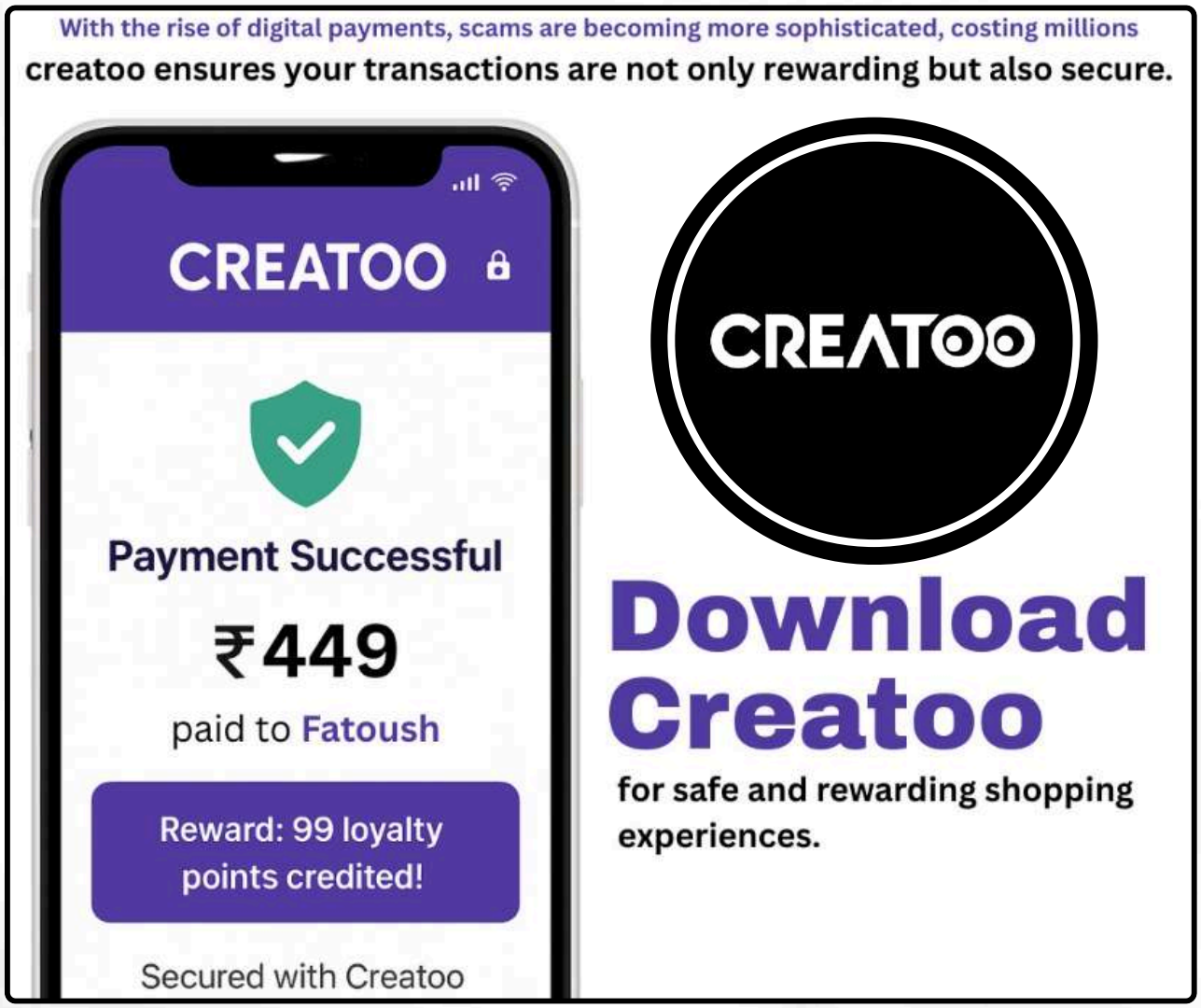
From Sip to Style: How Our Branding Team is Shaping Brands with Heart and Hustle

In the ever-vibrant campus of MIT-WPU, where conversations over coffee often spark million-dollar ideas, the Branding Team of the Budding Entrepreneurs Forum has been quietly setting the stage for tomorrow's iconic brands. We don't just promote, we tell stories, build vibes, and create unforgettable digital experiences. And our latest journey starts with flavor, friendship, and a whole lot of creativity.

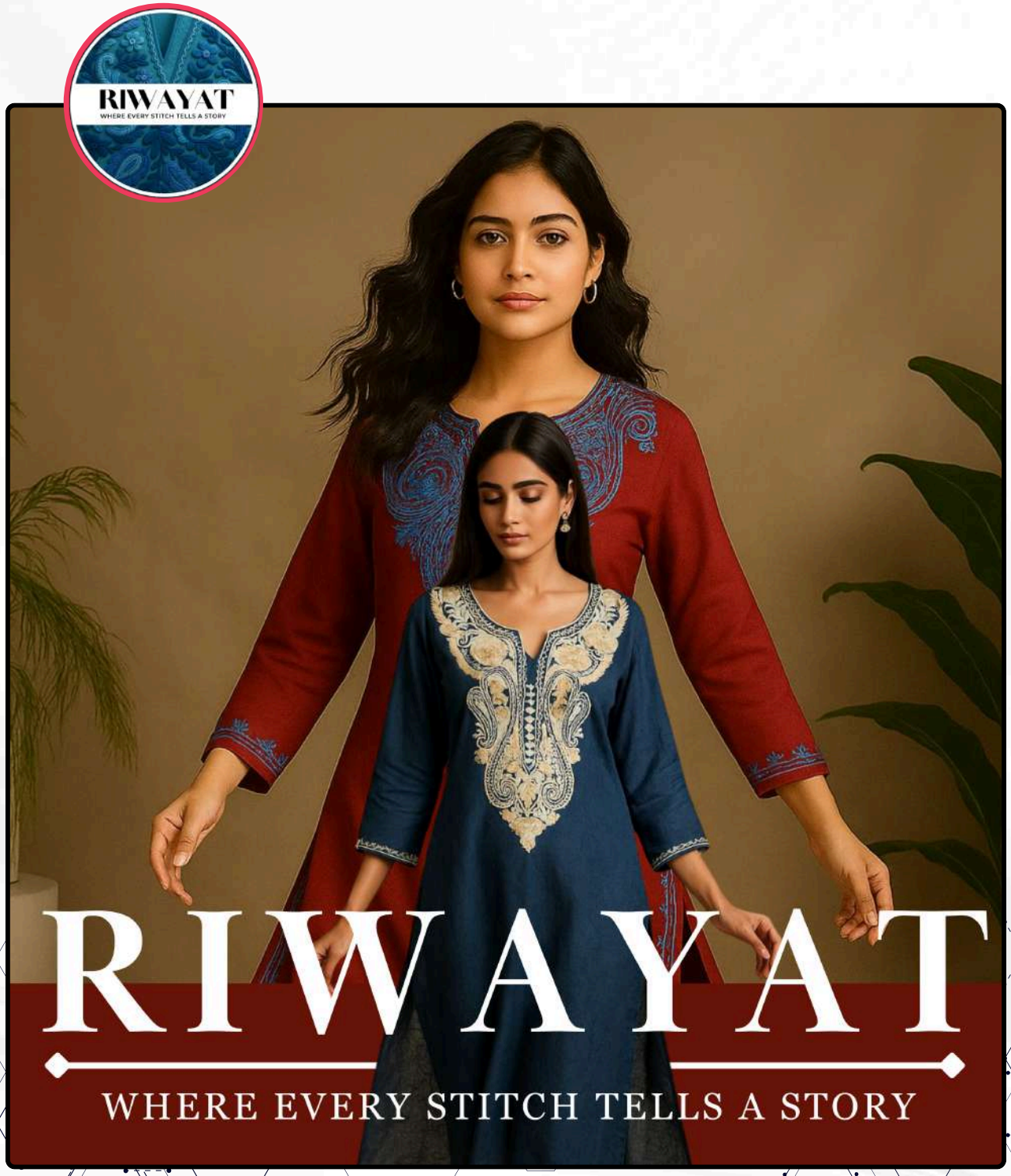
Introducing ENCAVE: More Than a Cafe, It's a Campus Mood.

June 2025 marked a fresh flavor for our team, our collaboration with Encave, the heartbeat of our college food scene. It's not just a cafe, it's where students find comfort food, cozy corners, and conversation. We wanted everyone to feel what Encave stands for. So, we got to work. Reels that vibe with your taste buds. Posts that scream "Let's eat here now!". Strategies that boosted visibility and customer love. From food photography to cafe culture highlights, we helped Encave become the go-to hangout spot students can't stop talking about.

Creatoo: The Brand That Got People Talking (and Tapping) Before Encave, we worked our storytelling magic with Creatoo. A simple idea turned into a brand that blew up Instagram with viral reels, smart meme marketing, and cool café tie-ins. Creatoo wasn't just seen. It was shared, saved, and celebrated.



Riwayat: Weaving Culture into Content Then came Riwayat, a brand deeply rooted in elegance and tradition. With hand-threaded Kashmiri kurtis that carry the soul of a region, Riwayat deserved a story just as beautiful. We redesigned the logo, crafted a poetic tagline, held aesthetic photoshoots, and reimagined the entire Instagram page. It wasn't just marketing. It was storytelling at its finest. Each kurti had a tale, and we made sure every post echoed it.



SO, WHAT SETS US APART?

We're not here to follow trends. We start them. We don't use branding templates, we build fresh ones for every project. Every brand we work with gets a strategy tailor-made to its heartbeat.

Whether it's content that connects, posts that perform, or vibes that go viral, we're here for it all. Our strength lies in how deeply we understand stories. We build brands the way people build friendships, with heart, time, and truth.

At the Budding Entrepreneurs Forum, we're not just branding experts. We're memory makers. Culture creators. Brand whisperers.

Budding Entrepreneurs Forum X Encave
Budding Entrepreneurs Forum X Riwayat
Budding Entrepreneurs Forum X Createoo

Let the journey continue...

Budding Entrepreneurs Forum Branding Team

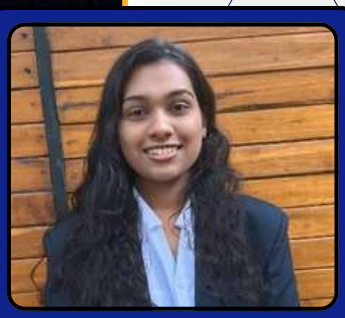
Written By:
Priyanka Nagar
MBA - IB

SUCCESS STORIES

ICICI Bank x Amazon Pay:
Back in 2018, ICICI and Amazon Pay dropped this co-branded credit card that basically screamed, “Hey, let’s make India swipe-happy!” No joining fees, no annual charges—just straight-up rewards. If you were an Amazon Prime member, you could snag up to 5% cashback on your Amazon buys. Not Prime? Still got some love—2% on Amazon Pay partner shops and 1% everywhere else. All that juicy cashback? It landed straight into your Amazon Pay balance, so you’d obviously go back and spend more. Smart move, right?

Honestly, this whole thing was a win-win-win. ICICI got a flood of new digital users, Amazon Pay got a big boost for their wallet system, and folks like us got easy rewards for just doing what we already do—shopping online. People in cities jumped on it, so did folks in smaller towns. Not even exaggerating, this card shot up to become one of the hottest co-branded cards in India. Pretty wild how fast people grabbed it.

LEGO x NASA — Building Dreams of Space:
LEGO and NASA teamed up, and it made learning about space super fun and interactive. They created detailed models like the Apollo Saturn V rocket, the Mars Rover, and the Space Shuttle Discovery, which got kids and adults excited about science and building things. The sets were not just toys but also a cool way to learn about what humans have done in space and get into STEM. For LEGO, it made them look even better as a brand that mixes fun with learning, and NASA got to reach more people and got them interested in space. It's a great example of how brands can tell stories and use games to make complicated topics easy to understand and interesting.



Written By:
Saanya Nair
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WHAT'S HAPPENING IN ENTREPRENEURSHIP WORLD ?

1. The 21by72 Startup Summit
Date: 14-15 June, 2025 | Venue: Avadh Utopia, Surat, Gujarat

The 21by72 Startup Summit is called as "Bharat's Biggest Startup Summit" because it is designed to bring together aspiring entrepreneurs and seasoned business leaders. The fourth season has attracted around 15,000 visitors and it has featured 100 exhibitors. It has showcased innovative ideas and solutions in the startup ecosystem. The event was organised by 21by72 which is a recognised name in the industry and personalised for top CEO's and founders that make it an ideal platform for networking and knowledge sharing. The summit has highlighted India's top five most popular startup sectors by providing insights about market opportunities. The participants were inspired by presentations on game changing ten tech startup ideas and nine creative ways of funding their dream businesses. The event was attended by Hon'ble Home Minister of Gujarat Shri. Harsh Sanghavi, Actress Neha Dhupia as the lead guests.

2. ICAI MSME'S & Startup Conclave 2025
Date: 26-27 June, 2025 | Venue: Hotel Sahara Star, Mumbai

The theme of the event was 'MSME FATHOM' which stands for the six foundational pillars of MSME success: Finance, Accounting, Tech Support, Human Resources, Operations and Marketing. The buzzline was "From funding to marketing automation to team building – gain the insights to run a smarter, faster, future-ready business." The event was organised on the eve of the international MSME day i.e. 27 June. The two day event has witnessed panel discussions on topics like Government initiatives towards MSME & Startup Ecosystem, bridging the financing gap-role of contemporary funding sources for successful MEMEs & Startups and more. The event has also featured fireside chats and keynotes, MSME Clinics (1:1 Real Time Advisory) and Startup Pitch Platform - 3P: Pitch, Pivot and Prosper with mentoring interactions.

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FORUM FACULTY MENTOR

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Forum Faculty Mentor

Dr. Vikram Shete
Forum Faculty Mentor

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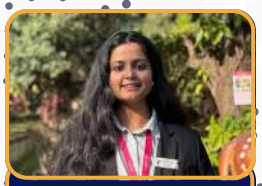
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